Hustle Hive CIC – Behaviour and Positive Conduct Policy

Item	Detail
Organisation	Hustle Hive CIC, company no. 16691281
Policy leads	Gavin Copland and Kieron Davis, Directors
Designated Safeguarding Lead	Gavin Copland
Version	2.0
Effective from	October 2026
Next review	September 2027, or sooner after a serious incident or a change in guidance

1. Purpose and principles

Hustle Hive CIC provides a safe, respectful and supportive place where young people can learn, grow in confidence and re-engage with education. Many of the young people we work with have experienced disengagement or exclusion from school, special educational needs or disabilities, trauma, mental health difficulties or instability at home.

Our approach is trauma-informed, relational and restorative. We start from the principle that behaviour communicates need, and we focus on safety, dignity and re-engagement rather than punishment. We do not use zero-tolerance systems that ignore a young person's context or needs.

Our aims are to:

- keep everyone safe;
- help young people manage their emotions;
- build positive relationships;
- encourage young people to take responsibility for their actions;
- help young people engage with learning; and

- reduce the risk of young people losing their place with us.

2. Scope

This policy applies to everyone taking part in Hustle Hive CIC activities, and to staff, volunteers and contractors. It covers our premises, off-site visits, outdoor learning, transport, holiday clubs, workshops, one-to-one mentoring and online sessions. Adults on our courses are expected to follow the same standards of respectful behaviour.

3. Expectations

Learners

We expect learners to:

- treat others with respect;
- follow reasonable instructions from staff;
- follow workshop rules and use equipment safely and only when allowed;
- respect property and the premises;
- avoid behaviour that could hurt themselves or others; and
- take part in activities as positively as they can.

Workshop rules are agreed with learners at the start of each placement or club, displayed on the wall and revisited regularly.

Staff

Staff will:

- model calm, respectful behaviour;
- set clear, consistent boundaries;
- notice triggers and early signs of escalation;
- use de-escalation rather than confrontation;
- never use humiliation, sarcasm, shouting or threats; and
- keep professional boundaries and put safety first.

4. Supporting positive behaviour

We promote positive behaviour through:

- clear routines and structure;

- strong relationships between staff and learners;
- achievable, hands-on tasks that give learners a sense of success;
- regular encouragement, praise and recognition;
- strength-based feedback; and
- flexible delivery that responds to each learner's needs.

Staff understand how trauma can affect behaviour, including fight, flight and freeze responses, sensory overload, difficulty regulating emotions and attachment difficulties. We focus on helping learners calm down (co-regulation) rather than on control. Each learner's individual risk assessment records known triggers and the strategies that help them.

Mobile phones

In alternative provision sessions, learners hand their phones to staff at the start of the session. Phones are stored securely and returned at the end of the day or at agreed break times. In holiday clubs and workshops, phones stay switched off and in bags. Exceptions are agreed in advance with the parent or carer and recorded, for example when a phone is used to monitor a medical condition or a young carer needs to be reachable.

No one may photograph, film or record other learners or staff. Staff may allow phones to be used for a learning activity under supervision.

5. Responding to behaviour

Early intervention and de-escalation

When behaviour starts to escalate, staff may offer reassurance, adjust the task, give choices, suggest a short break, move the learner to a calmer space or talk with them one-to-one, within safeguarding guidance. Staff use a calm voice and non-threatening body language, listen, acknowledge feelings, avoid confrontation in front of others, and allow space and time for the learner to calm down.

Graduated response

Our response is proportionate and focused on safety.

Level	When	Response
1. Supportive intervention	Low-level disruption or not following instructions	Verbal reminder, guidance, redirection

Level	When	Response
2. Regulation support	Behaviour is escalating or the learner is struggling to manage emotions	Break from the activity, calm space, extra staff attention
3. Removal from activity	Behaviour puts the learner or others at risk, or stops the activity running safely	Temporary withdrawal from the activity with a member of staff; parent or carer and school contacted if needed
4. Incident response	Serious risk of harm, aggression, threats, serious damage or a prohibited item	Activity stopped if needed; Gavin Copland or Kieron Davis takes charge; parent or carer and school told the same day; individual risk assessment and placement reviewed

Whatever the level, staff help the learner to reflect and repair harm once they are calm (see Restorative practice).

Physical intervention

Hustle Hive CIC does not use physical intervention as part of managing behaviour. Staff will only hold or guide a learner in exceptional circumstances, where this is necessary to prevent immediate harm to the learner or someone else and there is no safer alternative. Any intervention must be reasonable and proportionate, use the minimum force for the shortest possible time, and stop as soon as the risk has passed.

After any physical intervention:

1. The learner and staff are checked for injury and offered support.
2. The incident is recorded in full the same day, including what led up to it, what was done, how long it lasted and who saw it.
3. The parent or carer and the commissioning school are told the same day.
4. Staff and the learner each have a debrief.
5. The Directors review the incident and update the learner's individual risk assessment.

Restorative practice

Once everyone is calm, staff support restorative conversations: reflecting on what happened, understanding its impact, repairing harm and rebuilding relationships. Where a learner has had time away from an activity or a placement, we agree a plan to welcome them back.

Practices we never use

We never use:

- corporal punishment;
- degrading or humiliating treatment;
- collective punishment of a group for one person's behaviour;
- withholding food, drink, toilet access or other basic needs;
- unlawful physical restraint; or
- isolation in an unsafe space or locking a learner in a room.

6. Specific situations

Bullying and conflict between learners

Bullying, harassment, intimidation and discriminatory behaviour are not tolerated, whether in person or online. Staff step in promptly, support the person affected, address the reasons behind the behaviour, monitor relationships afterwards and tell parents, carers and schools where appropriate. Concerns about child-on-child abuse are handled under our Safeguarding policy.

Weapons, drugs, alcohol and other prohibited items

Learners must not bring weapons, illegal drugs, alcohol, vapes, lighters or any item that could cause harm. Hustle Hive CIC is not a school and does not have a school's legal powers to search learners, so staff do not search learners or their belongings. If staff believe a learner has a prohibited item, they:

1. calmly ask the learner to hand it over, without putting anyone at risk;
2. keep other learners away from the situation;
3. call the police on 999 if the item is a weapon or anyone is in danger, or if the learner refuses to hand over an item that could cause serious harm;
4. tell the parent or carer and the commissioning school the same day; and
5. record the incident and tell the Designated Safeguarding Lead, as the item may point to a safeguarding concern such as criminal exploitation.

Items handed over are stored securely and returned to the parent or carer, or passed to the police.

Damage to property

Where damage happens, we try to understand why, and use restorative actions such as helping to repair or tidy where appropriate. We may discuss repair or replacement costs with the parent, carer or commissioning school.

Off-site activities and transport

On visits and in the community, learners represent Hustle Hive CIC and are expected to behave safely and respectfully. In vehicles, learners must wear a seat belt, stay seated and not distract the driver. If behaviour becomes unsafe, staff end the activity or stop the vehicle somewhere safe. Transport or visits may be withdrawn for a learner whose behaviour makes them unsafe, and this is recorded in their individual risk assessment.

Sending a learner home early

We only send a learner home early when they cannot stay safely. A learner of school age is never sent home on their own. They are collected by a parent or carer, or taken home by staff as agreed with the parent or carer. For learners placed by a school or local authority, we tell the commissioning school straight away, because the learner remains on the school's roll and the school remains responsible for their education and safeguarding.

Suspending or ending a place

We may suspend or end a place when a learner's behaviour presents an unacceptable risk that we cannot reduce through reasonable adjustments. Before deciding, we consider the safety of others, the learner's needs, any adjustments we could make and alternative arrangements. For placed learners, we discuss this with the commissioning school before any decision, except where immediate action is needed for safety. All decisions are made by the Directors and recorded.

7. Recording and review

All Level 3 and Level 4 incidents, every physical intervention and every prohibited-item incident are recorded on the day. Records include the date and time, who was involved, what happened and what led up to it, what action was taken and the outcome. The Directors review behaviour records every month to spot patterns, update individual risk assessments and plan support.

8. Working with parents, carers and schools

We share behaviour concerns and successes with parents, carers and commissioning schools so that everyone supporting a young person takes a consistent approach. For placed learners, we follow any reporting arrangements agreed with the commissioning school.

9. Safeguarding

Challenging behaviour can be a sign that a young person is being harmed or is at risk, for example through abuse, neglect or exploitation. Staff always consider this and report concerns to the Designated Safeguarding Lead under our Safeguarding policy.

10. Equality and inclusion

We apply these expectations fairly while taking account of each learner's needs, disabilities and background, and we make reasonable adjustments in line with the Equality Act 2010.

11. Training and policy review

All staff are trained in this policy, de-escalation and trauma-informed practice during induction. This policy is reviewed every year, and sooner after a serious incident or a change in guidance.

Related policies

Read this policy alongside our Safeguarding, Health & Safety, Medical Needs and Medicines, Online Safety, and Equality, Diversity & Inclusion policies.

Approval and signatures

This policy has been approved by the Board of Directors of Hustle Hive CIC.

Name	Position	Signature	Date
Gavin Copland	Director and DSL		
Kieron Davis	Director		
Carey Viala	Director		

Name	Position	Signature	Date
Sarah Smith	Director		